Revana UI Redesign Plan

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Why the current UI reads as AI-generated

The UI looks generated because of a handful of repeated habits, and all of them are fixable.

- **Everything is monospace**, with tiny uppercase letter-spaced labels ("EVIDENCE GROUNDING", "ENTITY DOSSIER"). It cosplays a hacker terminal.
- **Navy plus neon cyan, with glows and gradients.** This is the default AI dark theme.
- **Every block is a bordered, rounded, colored card with an icon.** The answer is four stacked icon-cards (found, connect, mean, next) that differ only by border color. Real tools show hierarchy with size, weight and spacing.
- **Pills and badges on everything**: "Cross-Dataset Engine", "Multi-Database Engine", "LIVE". Most say nothing useful.
- **The floating gradient AI button** is the most chatbot-template element on screen.
- **Wasted screen space.** The graph, which is the real selling point, is squeezed into a thumbnail while chat text fills the page.

Design direction

The direction is neutral graphite with one accent, dense and quiet, in the vein of Palantir Foundry, Linear, Grafana and Bloomberg. Gray carries about 95% of the screen, and color appears only when it means something: selected, risky, live, broken.

Role	Value	Use
Background	`#0E0F11`	App canvas
Panel	`#151618`	Side panels, inspector
Raised / hover	`#1C1E21`	Hover rows, menus
Border	`#26292D`	Dividers only where needed
Text	`#E6E7E9`	Primary text

Role	Value	Use
Muted text	`#8B9097`	Secondary labels
Accent	`#4C90F0`	Selection, links, primary buttons (the only accent)
Status red / amber / green	`#E5484D` / `#F5A524` / `#3DB46D`	Semantic states only

Typography: Inter at 13px for the UI, in sentence case with no letter-spaced uppercase. Mono is for IDs, coordinates and numbers only.

Shape rules:

- 4px radius instead of 8 to 12px.
- Separate areas with spacing and subtle background shifts, not borders on everything.
- No glows, no gradients, no emoji.
- An icon goes on a button only when it adds meaning.
- Status is a small dot, not a pill.

Layout and navigation

The app becomes canvas-first: the graph or map fills the center, with filters or a list on the left and a context inspector on the right, as Palantir does it.

- **Left rail:** 48px wide, icons only, expanding on hover, in two groups.
  - *Workspace:* Map (the Digital Mirror), Graph, Investigations.
  - *Data:* Datasets, Entities, Resolution.
  - Data Sources merges into Datasets, since the 4-source system is disabled. Overview becomes a quiet home page or goes away.
- **Top bar:** about 40px thin. A breadcrumb on the left; on the right a command palette (Ctrl+K, "Search or ask…") and a small live-data status dot. The big search bar, the "0/4 Sources" box and the Sync button leave this bar.
- **AI as a docked right panel**, toggled with a key, replacing both the floating button and the full-page chat.
- **AI answers read like a short brief:** a plain paragraph, then a small Evidence list with citation numbers. Facts, inferences and hypotheses are marked with small inline labels instead of four boxed sections.

Content bugs in the screenshot

Two items on screen are wrong or misplaced regardless of styling.

- **"0/4 Sources Connected"** is inaccurate because that system is disabled in the code. Remove it.
- **The yellow "Cloud rate limit reached..." banner** appears over every answer. It belongs as a small status line inside the diagnostics drawer.

Build plan

The redesign goes in three steps, so nothing is hardcoded and each page can be reviewed on its own.

1. Put the design tokens (colors, type, radii) in the Tailwind config.
2. Rebuild the shell: top bar, left rail and page layout.
3. Redo pages one at a time: Investigation first (the one in the screenshot), then Graph, Map and Datasets.

Open questions

Three choices are still open before the rebuild starts.

- [ ] Dark only, or a light theme too? Light is easy to add later if everything uses tokens.
- [ ] Is this mainly for a resume and demo, or for real users? That decides how much polish goes into empty states and onboarding.
- [ ] Does the single blue accent work, or should it be something less common, like muted amber or teal?